

Communication skills

People communicate and interact with each other in different ways. Verbal communication involves speech and nonverbal involves body language. Communication depends on many factors, such as tone, volume, and vocabulary, as well as expression and movement.

SEE ALSO

◀ 22–23 Self-expression

◀ 84–85 Emotions

◀ 124–125 Speaking up

Interactions

190–191 ▶

The importance of communication

Good communication skills can be learned and will help a person in many aspects of life, such as building friendships and during job interviews. They can also help people to feel more connected, which is important for their happiness and well-being. People communicate with each other to share information and socialize, which is why communication skills are often called social skills.



▷ Handy gestures

Facial expressions, gesticulations, and body posture all give subtle clues to what a person is thinking and saying.

Verbal communication skills

Verbal speech is a direct way of communicating, while nonverbal methods are more subtle messages that add to what a person is saying. Choice of vocabulary and tone of voice affect the verbal communication and how it is received—and perceived—by the listener. Tailoring what is said and how it is said to the intended listener is also important, be it a peer, person in authority, or friend.

“Good words are worth much, and cost little.”

George Herbert, poet

Politeness

Simple good manners, such as saying “please” and “thank you,” show respect for, and consideration of, the other person.



Compliments

Expressing genuine admiration or praise for someone—be it their appearance, achievements, or personal qualities—cements the connection between two people. Compliments suggest approval, which is something that most people seek in social encounters.



Apologizing

When saying “sorry,” it is important to mean it. While it can be hard for a person to admit that they’re wrong, resolving conflict and bad feelings is a good skill to have. Often, it can lead to the other person apologizing for their part in the conflict, too.

